

Yuga or Xperia Z?

Sony's next flagship phone – the 5-inch C660X Xperia Yuga – is rumoured to get a more market-friendly name: Xperia Z

Exynos exploit to be fixed

Samsung has confirmed a reported vulnerability in the Exynos kernel code, pointed out that legit apps have no risk and promised to fix it soon

Phone company rankings and new global announcements...

The crown that was sitting tightly on Nokia's head was usurped by Samsung last year and Sony is now firmly placed in third spot... and other stories, of course

For the first time for quite a few months, the Indian mobile consumer has to wait for globally available products. Numerous top-of-the-line devices in the recent past have made their way to Indian shores just days, or weeks after their global launch.

This is not the case for the much-awaited LG Nexus 4 however, or Nokia's Lumia series of Windows Phone 8 devices. Of course, that doesn't mean the Indian market is not near saturated with capable devices across price points.

However, the more discerning consumer however, always waits on his purchase, until he's certain the device in consideration is truly future-proof, and not to be outdone (at least in that price range) almost immediately by another device.

Globally, the anticipation we've been describing in months past has finally died out, but these are interesting times, and by the end of Q1 2012 we'll start seeing smartphone platform adoption numbers which could show us if the smartphone market is still a one horse race, or if WP8 and iOS 6 are showing promising strides in the race of catch-up.

Stumbling RIM is certainly hoping that its BlackBerry 10 OS-based devices (expected in Q1 2013) will manage to gain them a new foothold, and quite a few consumers are expectant, at least in India. BBIO OS seems promising so far, and leaks of new devices such as the London

and Nevada are making their way online, with both full-touch and touch-and-type QWERTY devices rumoured.

Samsung becomes 2012's top mobile manufacturer

With Nokia struggling to cope with the competition, Samsung has emerged as the top phone maker (feature and smartphone) of 2012 – this is the first time since 1998 that Nokia has changed its position – according to new data from IHS iSuppli.

The report finds that Samsung accounted for about 29 percent of global mobile phone shipments, up from 21 percent in 2011 when it had grabbed the no. 2 spot. Nokia, in the meanwhile, has seen its shares dropping from 30 percent to 24 this year.

According to Wayne Lam, senior analyst for wireless communications at IHS, smartphones have emerged as the fastest-growing segment market as they account almost half of all wireless handset shipments in 2012.

IHS iSuppli points out that Samsung has released a lot of phones in a short span of time, launching dozens of new models each year, which range from high-end to budget devices. Nokia, the research firm notes, has only been "mired" in switching over its smartphones to Windows OS. Sales of Nokia's Symbian-based phones have gone down.

Sony becomes third-largest smartphone manufacturer

In the meanwhile, Sony is now comfortably in the third spot in the smartphone sales rankings. This has been established in the latest research from IDC, which states that in Q3'12, Sony holds a 4.8 per cent market share in the global smartphone market. This puts it in third place, behind Samsung and Apple.

Nokia's quarter on quarter market share dropped from 13.6 per cent to 3.4 per cent, while HTC dropped from 10.3 per cent to 4.7 per cent. RIM's went from 9.6 per cent to 4.2 per cent. For the top two, Samsung saw an increase from 22.7 percent to 31.3 per cent, while Apple improved from 13.8 per cent to 14.6 per cent.

Clearly, Sony's rise is partly because of the interesting Android phones it made this

year, and partly because of the decline of Nokia and HTC. From the figures mentioned earlier, Sony's market share actually fell slightly, but Nokia's and HTC's fell more.

LG Optimus L-series crosses 10 million sales mark

These are good times for LG's smartphone division. Its top-of-the-line Nexus 4 Android smartphone is the phone to buy, currently, and its close cousin – the Optimus G – remains equally coveted. And while LG's premium smartphones are in heavy demand, the company's highlighting the success of its Optimus L-series smartphones, which LG claims has crossed the 10 million mark in global sales.



Samsung Galaxy Grand



Sony Xperia E